



Pacific
Community
Communauté
du Pacifique

Yellowfin 2026 Assessment

Overview of Results and Discussion Points



Arni Magnusson

FFA Caucus

13 August 2026, Apia

Model development

Spatial structure

1. Consider single-region or equatorial model
2. Revise regional structure (esp. bigeye)

Fisheries

3. Convert weight comps to length comps
4. Combine fisheries
5. Lower effective sample size in general
6. Analyze data conflict, identify and test different approaches
7. Possibly reduce sample size in regions without otolith data
8. Consider different scenarios for Indonesian catches
9. Consider using size composition from predominant nation in some fisheries

Recruitment

10. Orthogonal polynomial recruitment

Natural mortality

11. Fix at different levels of M

Movement

12. SEAPODYM coefficients

Growth

13. Reweight otoliths based on location
14. Richards curve

Selectivity

15. Length-based

Tags

16. Mixing period for each release group

CPUE

17. Alternative indices
18. Time-varying CV
19. Effort creep

Shiny app with stepwise results:

<https://ofp-sam.shinyapps.io/yft-2026-stepwise>













